

TOPIC 2: BASIC COMPUTER COMMUNICATION NETWORKS

1. Meaning of a Network

A computer network is a group of computers and other devices connected so that they can share data, resources (printers, files) and communication. Networking allows people and machines to work together efficiently.

2. Need for Networks

- Share files and software
- Share hardware (printers, scanners)
- Communicate (email, messaging, video calls)
- Access central databases and the internet
- Reduce cost by sharing resources

3. Types of Networks by Size

- **LAN (Local Area Network)** – covers a small area (school, office, home).
- **MAN (Metropolitan Area Network)** – covers a city or large campus.
- **WAN (Wide Area Network)** – covers a large geographical area (country or world); the internet is the largest WAN.

4. Summary

Networks connect computers to share resources and communicate. LAN, MAN and WAN describe networks of increasing size.

End of Topic 2